Wide Area Networks (WAN): Wide area networks include all the networks which are involved in transporting information from one geographical location to another. One of the most significant aspects of a wide area network is the involvement of a public telecommunication authority.

Personal Area Network (PAN): A personal area network (PAN) is a computer network used for data transmission amongst devices such as computers, telephones, tablets and personal digital assistants.

Metropolitan Area Network (MAN): A metropolitan area network (MAN) is a computer network that interconnects users with computer resources in a geographic area or region larger than that covered by even a large local area network (LAN) but smaller than the area covered by a wide area network (WAN).

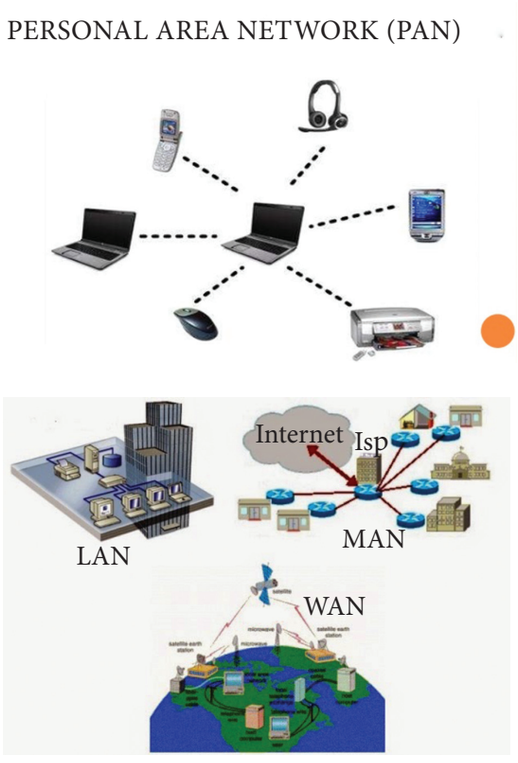


Fig.6.6. Computer Network

6.9. Internet and Intranet and Basic Internet Terms:

Internet: The Internet is the global computer network providing a variety of information and communication facilities, consisting of interconnected networks using standardized communication protocols. It is a network of networks that consists of private, public, academic, business, and government networks of local to global scope, linked by a broad array of electronic, wireless, and optical networking technologies. The Internet carries a vast range of information resources and services, such as the inter-linked hyper text documents and applications of the World Wide Web (WWW), electronic mail, telephone, and file sharing.

Intranet: An intranet is a private network that is contained within an enterprise. It may consist of many interlinked local area networks and also use leased lines in the wide area network. The main purpose of an intranet is to share company information and computing resources among employees. An intranet can also be used to facilitate working in groups and for teleconferences.An intranet uses TCP/IP, HTTP, and other Internet protocols and in general look like a private version of the Internet.

There's One Major Distinction between an Intranet and the Internet: The Internet is an open, public space, while an intranet is designed to be a private space. An intranet may be accessible from the Internet, but as a rule it's protected by a password and accessible only to a company's employees or other authorized users.

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